

Ministry of Forests, Lands, Natural Resource Operations and Rural Development

Flood Watch – Upper Fraser River

Issued: 12:00PM June 27, 2021

The River Forecast Centre is **upgrading** to a **Flood Watch** for the **Upper Fraser River** including:

- **Upper Fraser River including the Robson Valley and areas from Sinclair Mills upstream to Torpy, Dome Creek, McBride and surrounding tributaries**

Hot temperatures over the past several days have triggered significant amount of snowmelt at the higher elevations of the Upper Fraser River. Automated snow weather stations located in this basin recorded maximum temperatures of 24 to 32°C at the higher elevations on Saturday. The stations with remaining snow melted between 55 and 85-mm snow water equivalent yesterday. Environment and Climate Change Canada (ECCC) forecasts the hottest days to occur beginning today through Tuesday in the Upper Fraser region, and may even last into Wednesday. The current forecast at McBride has the following maximum temperatures, Sunday: 36°C, Monday: 39°C, Tuesday: 40°C, Wednesday: 38°C. These high temperatures will increase the snowmelt which will cause river levels to continue to rise in the coming days.

The status of rivers in the region are as follows:

- FRASER RIVER AT RED PASS (08KA007) is flowing at 290 m³/s (5-year return period) and is forecast to continue rising through the week.
- FRASER RIVER AT MCBRIDE (08KA005) is flowing at 1080 m³/s (between 5-year and 10-year return period) and forecast to continue rising.
- DORE RIVER NEAR MCBRIDE (08KA001) reached 118 m³/s (5-year flow) on Saturday evening and is expected to have higher evening peaks over the upcoming days. The highest peak will likely occur on the hottest day.
- MCKALE RIVER NEAR 940M CONTOUR (08KA009) reached approximately 90 m³/s (5-year flow) on Saturday evening and could reach higher flows on the warmer days.
- MORKILL RIVER BELOW HELLROARING CREEK (08KA013) reached approximately 315 m³/s (2-year flow) on Saturday evening and could reach higher flows on the warmer days.

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Details of the CLEVER Model forecasts for this region can be found at:

http://bcrfc.env.gov.bc.ca/freshet/map_clever.html

The public is advised to stay clear of the fast-flowing rivers and potentially unstable riverbanks during the high-streamflow period.

The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.